INTRODUCTION TO ISLAM

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HADITH AND SUNNAH

(Compilation, Classification, and Significance)

Lecture # I, Part III

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OVERVIEW

This lecture gives an in-depth study of the fundamental concepts of Hadith and Sunnah, their significance in Islamic teachings, and their meanings. It reviews the distinction between Hadith, which are the documented sayings and actions of the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ), and Sunnah, which are his practical example and lifestyle. The lecture explores the classification and categories of Hadith with respect to their authenticity and characteristics, as well as the structure of the Isnad (chain of narrators) and Matan (text). It also emphasizes the historical endeavours of compilation by early scholars and the critical role of Hadith in the comprehension of the Qur'an, the formation of Islamic jurisprudence, and the provision of moral and spiritual guidance for Muslims. Students will acquire a fundamental comprehension of these subjects and their significance in the context of Islamic thought and practice.

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WHAT WE DISCUSS

- Basic concepts of Hadith
  - Meaning of Hadith
  - Meaning of Sunnah
  - Difference between Hadith and Sunnah
- Classification or Types of Hadith
- Structure of Hadith
- History or Compilation of Hadith
- Significance of Hadith

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BASIC CONCEPTS OF HADITH

فَعَلَيْكُمْ بِسُنَّتِي

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HADITH

- A Hadith is a report of the sayings or actions of Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) together with the list of its chain of narration.
- Allah states in Holy Quran, (Al' Quran 53:3-4)

وَمَا يَنطِقُ عَنِ ٱلْهَوَىٰٓ (3) إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ (4)

And he (the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ) does not speak out of his own desire.

It is not but a revelation revealed (to him).

- Whatever Rasulullah (ﷺ) did or said, was all under the Divine Guidance and Control. In other words, we can say that Hadith is a Divine Word but indirectly as compared to the Qur'an which is directly Divine words.

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HADITH

- The “Hadith (حدیث)” word is derived from “Tahdis (تحد یث)”, the meaning “to inform”.
- The word Hadith means news, report, or narration.
- The words "Khabar (خبر)" and "Athar (اثر)" are synonyms for the word “Hadith”.
- Hadith stands for the report of words and deeds, approval or disapproval of Rasulullah (ﷺ). **OR**
- In Islamic terminology, Hadith refers to the sayings, actions, and tacit approval of the Holy Prophet ﷺ for any action.
- Furthermore, the Hadith word refers to the sayings, actions and approvals attributed to the Sahabah or Tabieen. (the word **Athar – اثر** used for this Hadith)

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SUNNAH

SUNNAH means practice, path and behavior in the Arabic language, and the word Sunnah used for “a manner, a rule of conduct, a mode of life, or step by step follow to anyone.”



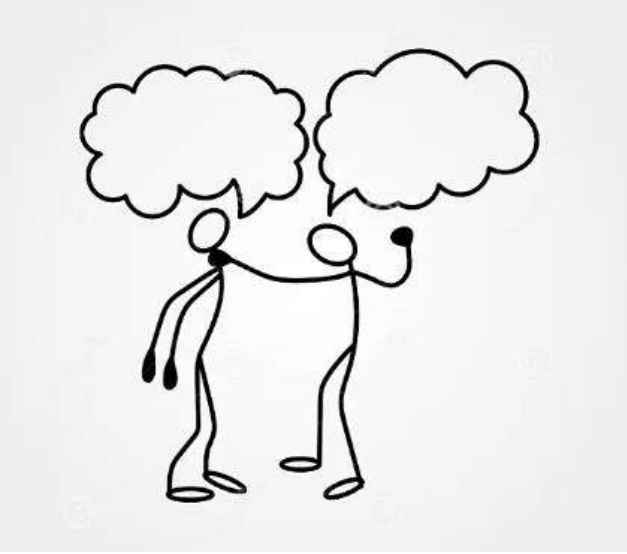
- The dictionary meaning of Sunnah is method and as a term of Islamic jurisprudence (Shariah). It means the method of Holy Prophet (ﷺ).
- The Holy Prophet (ﷺ) showed us how to live in this world, how to interact with people, without letting it get into our hearts. It indicates the doing of the Holy Prophet (ﷺ).
- Sunnah means the way of the Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him). It includes everything he said, did, and approved of.

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HADITH AND SUNNAH

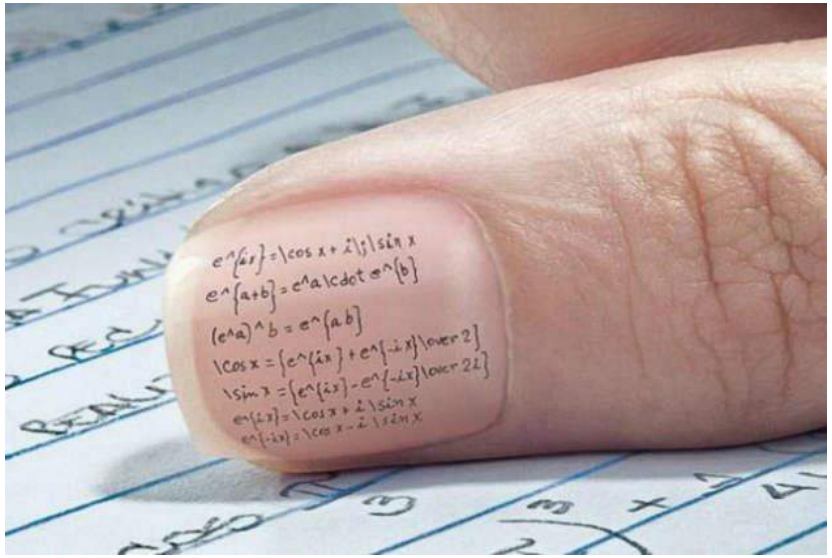
اجتنب الغضب

Avoid anger



من غشنا فليس منا

He who cheats us is not one of us.



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CLASSIFICATION OF HADITH

Basically, Hadith divided in many types which are based on authentication, according to nature of Matan and sanad, numbers of narrators, according to reference to a particular authority of narrators, according to authenticity of correspondents (Narrators),

Here we discuss the basic types of Hadith and Hadith e Nabvi, and types of Hadith through according to the number of narrators, according to reference to a particular authority of narrators, according to authenticity of correspondents (Narrators) and on the basis of strength of narrators.

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CLASSIFICATION OF HADITH

Types of Hadith

Fundamentally Hadith is of two kinds

1. **Hadith-e-Qudsi(Divine Hadith)**

It is the Hadith narrated by the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) on behalf of Allah, (saying "So says Allah").

2. **Hadith Nabvi (Hadith of Holy Prophet (ﷺ)**

It means sayings (Aqwaals) Actions (Afaals) and Approved actions (not prohibited by Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).

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TYPES OF HADITH E NABVI ﷺ

There are three components or there are three basic kinds of Hadith e Nabvi ﷺ.

1. **Hadith Qowli (Sayings):** what Prophet said and spoke himself.
2. **Hadith Faili (Action):** The action of Prophet what he performed and demonstrated.
3. **Hadith Taqriri (Permissions):** which comes from Prophet silence regarding any action. [It refers to the sayings and acts of the people performed in the presence of the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) or his absence. Later, he was informed about them, and the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) kept calm and did not comment. In other words, they were the Approved Actions of People by the Holy Prophet (ﷺ).]

These three kinds of components taken together are called Hadith (Nabvi), in which some scholars of Hadith also include the attributes and manners of the Prophet (ﷺ).

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TYPES OF HADITH

Hadith

- Hadith-e-Qudsi
- Hadith Nabvi
  - Hadith Faili
  - Hadith Qowli
  - Hadith Taqriri

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DIVISION OF HADITH ON THE BASIS OF STRENGTH OF NARRATORS

This can be is divided into two groups:

Khabar e Mutawaatir (خبر متواتر)

Hadith which is reported by such a large number of people that they cannot be expected to agree upon a lie, all of them together. Mutawatir meaning "Consecutive".

Khabar e Wahid (خبر واحد)

A Hadith whose narrators are not as many as those of "Khabar-ul-Mutawaatir", Narrated by a limited number of individuals (less than 10 Narrators). Ahad meaning "Isolated".

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ACCORDING TO REFERENCE TO A PARTICULAR AUTHORITY

Types of Hadith depending on who it is attributed to:

Hadith e Qudsi: These were sent directly from Allah to the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ who then passed it on to his companions.

Hadith e Marfu: A text in which the sayings, actions and approvals are attributed to Rasulullah ﷺ. **OR** (These were directly heard from the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ by His companions.)

Hadith e Mauquf: A text in which the sayings, actions etc, are attributed to a Sahabi. **OR** (It is a kind of command which was directly given by Prophet Muhammad ﷺ to his companions who forwarded it.)

Hadith e Maqtu: A text in which the sayings, actions etc, are attributed to a Tabi'ee. **OR** (It is a form of Instruction which is plainly described by Successor in his own words.)

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ACCORDING TO AUTHENTICITY

Types of Hadith concerning the reliability of its narrators, Basically we are discussing four types here.

- **Sahih (Authentic / Sound):** Transmitted through an unbroken chain of narrators all of whom are of sound character and memory.
- **Hasan (Approved or Good):** Transmitted through an unbroken chain of narrators all of whom are of sound character but weak memory (one of them).
- **Dhaif (Weak):** which cannot gain the status of **Hadith e Hasan** because it lacks one or more elements of a **Hadith e Hasan**. For example, if the narrator is not of sound memory and sound character, or if there is a hidden fault in the narrative or if the chain of narrators is broken. Weak Hadith raise many questions about its authenticity.
- **Mawdu:** The meaning is "Fabricated". Fabricated and wrongly ascribed to the Holy Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).

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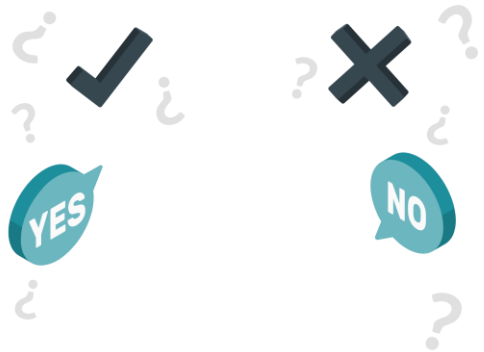
CONDITIONS FOR ACCEPTABILITY OF HADITH

1. No breaks in the chain of narrators.
2. All of the narrators in the chain are people of integrity (عادل).
3. All of the narrators in the chain are proficient (dhaabit - ضابط).
4. The text or chain of the narration does not contradict stronger reports or evidence.
5. Contains no hidden damaging defects. (Hidden damaging defects in the sense that during a detailed study there are issues found that can affect the validity of the hadith.)

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POINT TO BE NOTED

A hadith has to violate only one of the above conditions for it to be considered weak.



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STRUCTURE OF HADITH

حَدَّثَنَا الْحُمَيْدِيُّ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ الزُّبَيْرِ ، قَالَ: حَدَّثَنَا سُفْيَانُ ، قَالَ: حَدَّثَنَا يَحْيَى بْنُ سَعِيدٍ الْأَنْصَارِيُّ ، قَالَ: أَخْبَرَنِي مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ إِبْرَاهِيمَ التَّيْمِيُّ ، أَنَّهُ سَمِعَ عَلْقَمَةَ بْنَ وَقَّاصٍ اللَّيْثِيَّ ، يَقُولُ: سَمِعْتُ عُمَرَ بْنَ الْخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَلَى الْمِنْبَرِ، قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، يَقُولُ: " إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ، وَإِنَّمَا لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مَا نَوَى، فَمَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى دُنْيَا يُصِيبُهَا أَوْ إِلَى امْرَأَةٍ يَنْكِحُهَا، فَهِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى مَا هَاجَرَ إِلَيْهِ "

Narrated 'Umar bin Al-Khattab:

I heard Allah's Messenger ﷺ saying, "The reward of deeds depends upon the intentions and every person will get the reward according to what he has intended. So whoever emigrated for worldly benefits or for a woman to marry, his emigration was for what he emigrated for."

(Sahih al-Bukhari)

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STRUCTURE OF HADITH

Sanad

حَدَّثَنَا الْحُمَيْدِيُّ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ الزُّبَيْرِ ، قَالَ: حَدَّثَنَا سُفْيَانُ ، قَالَ: حَدَّثَنَا يَحْيَى بْنُ سَعِيدٍ الْأَنْصَارِيُّ ، قَالَ: أَخْبَرَنِي مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ إِبْرَاهِيمَ التَّيْمِيُّ ، أَنَّهُ سَمِعَ عَلْقَمَةَ بْنَ وَقَّاصٍ اللَّيْثِيَّ ، يَقُولُ: سَمِعْتُ عُمَرَ بْنَ الْخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَلَى الْمِنْبَرِ، قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، يَقُولُ:

Matan

إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ،

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PARTS OF HADITH

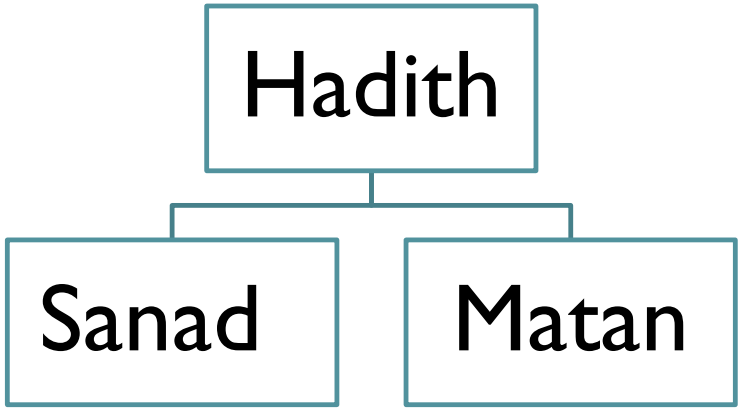
A hadith is composed of two main parts that are quite different from each other:

Sanad (Sequence of Reporters)

A series of correspondents through which Hadith has spread. It is the chain of narrators of the Hadith. It consists of all who narrated the text, starting with the last narrator and ending with the Holy Prophet Muhammad(ﷺ).

Matan (Content)

The central passage is the actual center of attraction for the reader. It usually talks about the right way of action in different circumstances of life.



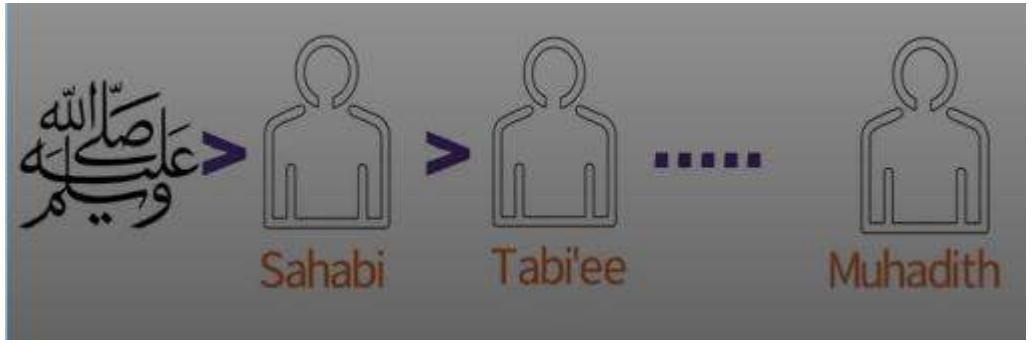
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WHO IS RAWI?



Rawi:

Rawi is the Arabic word for "narrator". It is one of the narrators of the text mentioned in the chain.



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اَلحَدِيث

HISTORY OF HADITH

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COMPILATION OF HADITH

- The first stage relates to the period of the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) till 10 A.H.
- The second stage is approximately from 11 A.H. to 100 A.H. This is the period of Sahaba, the companions of the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).
- The third stage is from about 101 A.H to nearly 200 A.H. This is the period of the Tabi'in, the followers of the companions of the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).
- The fourth stage is roughly from 200 A.H. to 300 A.H. This is the period of Taba Tabi'in, the followers of the followers.

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COMPILATION DURING LIFE OF HOLY PROPHET MUHAMMAD (ﷺ)

Like the Holy Quran, word and acts of the Holy Prophets (ﷺ) were also preserved by his Companions. Companions of the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) gave extreme importance and value to the Holy Prophet's (ﷺ) saying and deeds because Almighty Allah said in the Holy Quran,

"And he (the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ) does not speak out of his own desire. It is not but a revelation revealed (to him)." (Al' Quran 53:3-4)

وَمَا يَنطِقُ عَنِ ٱلْهَوَىٰٓ (3) إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ (4)

Holy Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) himself would give instructions about the transmission of what he taught, (بلغوا عني ولو آية) "Preach what you hear me say."

* The companions had three methods of learning or preservation of the Hadith; **memorization, writing and practice**.

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- There is another report according to which on the Farewell Pilgrimage, the Holy Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said,

  “He who is present here should carry this message to him who is absent.”

- At Madina the Holy Prophet himself appointed some persons to acquire knowledge of Islam. These were called as Ashabb-us-Suffah (the people of Bench).
- Suffah means shaded area or an area covered by some roof. It was a shaded raised platform constructed along the rear/northern wall of al-Masjid al-Nabawi (Muhammad's Mosque) assigned for residence and educational activities of the poor and needy. Most of the Hadith of that time were compiled and narrated by Ashaab-us-Suffaha and their guide and teacher was the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) himself.
- The most famous narrators are Abu Hurairah (RA), Abduallah bin Masood, Abdullah bin Umar, Abdullah bin Abbas, Anas bin Malik and many more.

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COLLECTION AND COMPILATION AFTER THE DEATH OF HOLY PROPHET (ﷺ)

After the passing of Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ), Islam spread rapidly, sparking a keen interest among new converts to learn about his life and teachings. The companions, having directly learned from the Prophet, became the primary authorities on Hadith and Sunnah.

Prominent companions such as Abu Hurairah (RA), Abdullah bin Abbas (RA), Abdullah bin Umar (RA), and Anas bin Malik (RA) were sought out by people from various regions to gain insights into the Prophet's life. Additionally, the wives of the Prophet, including Hazrat Aisha (RA) and Hazrat Hafsa (RA), played vital roles as transmitters of Hadith.

During this period, notable collections of Hadith, such as Sahifa al-Sadiqa, Sahifa Anas bin Malik and Sahifa Ali bin Abi talib emerged, serving as valuable resources for preserving and disseminating prophetic wisdom.

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Prominent Written Works

- Sahifa e Sadiqa
(Hazrat Abdullah bin Amar)

- Saheefa e Ali
(Hazrat Ali bin Abi Talib)

- Sahifa Anas bin Malik
(Hazrat Anas bin Malik)

- Book of Sa'ad
(Hazrat Sa'ad bin Ubadah)

- Book of Jabir
(Hazrat Jabir bin Abdullah)

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THE AGE OF COMPANION (11-100 AH)

During this period the companions spread far and wide and settled in almost all the countries conquered by the Muslims.

Notable Works: Contributions of scholars like

- Imam Ibn e Shihab Al Zuheri (Madinah),
- Imam Shabi (Kufa)
- Imam Makhol (Sham).

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THE AGE OF FOLLOWERS OF THE COMPANIONS (TABAEENS 101-200 AH)

This is the age of followers of the companions of the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).

The Hanafi and Maliki School of Legal thoughts were formulated during this period in the light of the ahadith.

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AGE OF FOLLOWERS OF THE FOLLOWERS (TABA TABAEEN 200-300 AH)

This is Golden age of Traditions. The six authentic books of traditions (al Sahah –al Sitta) were written. These are the most reliable books of traditions.

- Sahih Bukhari by Imam Muhammad bin Ismail Bukhari (RA)
- Sahih Muslim compiled by Imam Muslim bin Hajjaj (RA)
- Jami Tirmidhi compiled by Imam abu Isa Tirmidhi (RA)
- Sunan of Abu Daud compiled by Imam Abu Daud (RA)
- Sunan of Nisai compiled by Imam Abu Abdur Rahman Ahmed Nisai (RA)
- Sunan of ibn Majah compiled by Imam Abu Abdullah (RA).

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THANK YOU

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